

# ARTEM POTLOG

apotlog@protonmail.com | +971 55 214 69 53 | EU Citizen | UAE based

Strategy / corporate development leader (12 years) with CFO tenure and deal execution across CIS, Central Asia, MENA. Led \$3B+ capital programs and \$500M+ M&A across energy, natural resources and infrastructure; authored 20+ Board/IC-grade investment cases; delivered +70% NPV and +200 bps IRR outcomes. MSc in Petroleum Engineering, applied ML research.

## EXPERIENCE

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**Heriot-Watt University** - Research affiliate in [geodatascience.hw.ac.uk](https://geodatascience.hw.ac.uk) lab    *Edinburgh, UK and remote; Jul 2025 - Present*

- Published (IAMG 2026, Montreal): ML rock-type classification with uncertainty quantification for subsurface modeling.

**CIS-based \$500 Mn family office** - Advisor (part-time)    *CIS and remote; Mar 2024 - Present*

- Support founder on Central Asia upstream deals (KZ, UZ, TM, KG): asset evaluation, data rooms, investment memos.

**Gazprom Neft** - Program Manager, MENA and Caspian Strategy    *Dubai, UAE; Nov 2022 - Mar 2024*

- Led framing, concept selection and CAPEX phasing for 3 assets (>\$2B CAPEX) in a new jurisdiction. Scope spanned subsurface, surface facilities, pipelines and processing infrastructure, across multi-contractor EPC/BOT delivery.
- Led host government negotiations; developed market entry strategy options (Operator/Minority/Integrated Services) and supported legal structures and funding schemes for FID. Delivered 200 bps IRR improvement from JV/PSC structure.
- Negotiated a limited-liability interim period during technical audit, preventing blind entry into aging infrastructure and avoiding \$500 Mn unplanned CAPEX.

**Repsol** (\$500 Mn Exploration JV, 50 FTE) - CFO (01.2022 - interim CEO)    *Moscow, Russia; Dec 2020 - Nov 2022*

- Transitioned a \$500M-scale asset from unviable to Board-approved investment (+70% NPV uplift) by integrating a technical redesign, operational synergies with the adjacent partner, and a renegotiated fiscal regime with government.
- As CEO, orchestrated two back-to-back M&A transactions (Repsol's 100% exit, then 50% sale to Lukoil) and stood up the new JV's governance, while keeping field operations, drilling operations and finance function running without interruption.

**Gazprom Neft** - Manager, Strategy    *Erbil, Iraq; Dubai, UAE; Mar 2014 - Dec 2020*

- Drove \$1B Iraqi Kurdistan investment case for 3 exploration assets in 2 months; secured BoD approval.
- Led Board-approved MENA strategy: country screening, fiscal-regime benchmarking, priority-market modeling and target-asset profiling for international growth.
- Authored 20+ decision-grade investment cases and Investment Committee materials for Iraq 5th Licensing Round, ADNOC exploration rounds, and \$1B+ A&D evaluations (Shell Egypt portfolio, Kuwait Energy assets).

**Gazprom Neft** - Senior specialist, BD    *Saint-Petersburg (HQ), Moscow, Noyabrsk, Russia; Nov 2011 - Mar 2014*

- Developed risk-service framework unlocking access to oil-rim resources (1 Bn toe, 2P) - key growth drivers through 2035.
- Closed \$2M energy-transition deal (Kyoto ERU); coordinated subsidiary C-suites, auditors and banks in collapsing market.
- Evaluated gas utilization / power projects (CNG/LNG, electricity supply); contributed to associated-gas monetization goal.

## EDUCATION

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**Heriot-Watt University** - MSc, Petroleum Engineering    *Edinburgh, UK; Sep 2024 - Dec 2025*

- Thesis: machine learning for petrophysics applications (Merit). Team lead of group Field Development Plan project.

**St. Petersburg State University of Economics** - Double Diploma: Finance and Law    *Russia; Sep 2007 - Jul 2012*

## SKILLS

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Problem solving: Hypothesis-driven analysis, structured decomposition, IC/Board storyboarding, stakeholder negotiation.

Analytics: Python (Pandas, NumPy, TensorFlow, XGBoost); DCF/NPV/IRR/EMV; Monte Carlo, Bayesian UQ.

Sector: Energy (O&G, power, CCS, hydrogen), natural resources, infrastructure (EPC/EPCM, PSC/BOT/concession).